CI/CD · FALSE CONFIDENCE · 1/10

Green CI never saw garbage input.

Why passing tests is evidence for code, not a warranty for the world.

10 slides · swipe

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Green means 'tested paths pass'. Nothing else.

I have shipped a fully-green pipeline that fed the app: malformed records, incomplete order rows, stale config, contradictory generated answers. Every test smiled.

CI tests the map.
Production is the territory.

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What still walks through green CI.

01 Records with fields the schema allows but semantics don't

02 Addresses that pass format but not reality

03 Config drift between what repo says and prod runs

04 Contradictory states (paid but unshipped, shipped but unpaid)

05 LLM output that is valid JSON and invalid sense

Every one passed my tests. None passed the customer.

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What I added beyond tests.

01 Schema validation at the boundary — reject, don't sanitize

02 Input contracts for every write path (types + invariants)

03 Canary assertion on first real request after deploy

04 Explicit unknown-state handling, never a silent default

Tests prove the code. Contracts prove the input.

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Where the warranty ends.

INSIDE

What CI guarantees

deterministic checks
pass / fail
on known inputs

OUTSIDE

What the world sends

malformed rows
incomplete forms
called it fixed

The trusted inner loop cannot vouch for the outer mess.

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The habit that caught more than tests.

Before any deploy: run the production-shaped data through the new code path once. One real file, one real query — the canary request. Tests verify hope; the canary verifies reality.

Tests pass.
Then one real thing happens.

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The lie green CI tells best.

If it compiles, it validates — and if it validates, it works in production.

Both clauses are false, but we ship on them anyway.

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Questions worth asking your pipeline.

01 What input shape was never tested?

02 What happens on empty/null at every write path?

03 Can a human replay a failed request?

04 Does the deploy check the first real request?

If you can't answer, your CI is decorative.

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The rule for pipelines.

Testing is evidence for the code you wrote, not a warranty for everything that enters the pipe. Make both claims explicit — don't let green paint cover a gray input.

Evidence for code.
Warranty for inputs.
Never confuse them.

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CI/CD · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next CI run.

When the next build is green, ask what the world sends the next time. If your pipeline can't answer, neither can your incident review.

Save for later review

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